

SAMPLE REPORT - Alex Chen, Marketing Manager (Tech)

TARGET ROLE: Marketing Manager

54

out of 100

"Reads like a job description, not a career story - you're listing tasks, not proving impact."

01 SCORE BREAKDOWN

ATS Compatibility	61/100
Executive Presence	48/100
Clarity	58/100
Strategic Positioning	44/100
Credibility Signals	52/100
Impact Evidence	39/100
Industry Translation	67/100

02 TOP ISSUES

- 1. No quantified outcomes - every bullet describes a task, none prove a result
- 2. Your summary reads like a LinkedIn cliché - 'results-driven marketing professional' tells hiring managers nothing
- 3. ATS will filter you out for 'Content Marketing Manager' roles because that exact phrase never appears

03 FIRST IMPRESSION

"Busy resume. Not a compelling one."

WHAT YOUR RECRUITER ACTUALLY THINKS:

In six seconds a recruiter sees: mid-level generalist with broad marketing exposure but no clear ownership of anything significant. The layout is dense and uniform - nothing jumps out. There's no obvious career narrative threading the roles together. The eye lands on job titles and company names, then loses interest because the bullets all start with the same passive verbs.

HIREABILITY VERDICT:

Borderline - gets past an initial skim but unlikely to make the shortlist without a referral. The experience is real and relevant but the resume doesn't make the hiring manager's job easy. They have to work to find the value, and most won't bother.

04 ATS RISK

Risk Level: Medium

KEYWORD GAPS:

- 'Content Marketing Manager' - your target title - appears nowhere in the document
- 'Go-to-market' and 'GTM strategy' are standard tech marketing terms that are absent
- 'Marketing funnel', 'demand generation', and 'pipeline' - common ATS filters for this level
- 'Cross-functional collaboration' and 'stakeholder management' missing from senior role applications

FORMATTING ISSUES:

- Skills section uses a horizontal comma-separated list - ATS parsers often misread this
- Table used for education section - invisible to most ATS systems
- Non-standard section heading 'Career Snapshot' instead of 'Summary' or 'Profile'

QUICK FIXES:

- Add a 'Core Competencies' grid replacing the inline skills list
- Rename 'Career Snapshot' to 'Professional Summary'
- Mirror the exact job title from listings you're targeting in your summary
- Rebuild the education section as plain text, no tables

05 HARD TRUTH

CORE DISCONNECT:

You're applying for a Marketing Manager role but your resume positions you as a marketing executor. There's a fundamental difference - managers own outcomes and lead strategy; executors deliver tasks. Every bullet on your resume describes what you did, not what changed because you did it. Hiring managers at this level are looking for someone who can own a function, not just fill it.

WHAT RECRUITERS ACTUALLY SEE:

A capable marketer who has touched a lot of things - social, email, events, content - but hasn't owned any of them. The tech industry context works in your favour, but without metrics there's no proof of performance. You look like a solid number-two who needs to be managed, not a future manager who runs a team.

WHERE YOUR EXPERIENCE GETS LOST:

Your 3 years at Brightwave Technologies is the strongest part of your background, but the resume allocates it only 4 bullets - the same as your 8-month contract role. The depth is buried. A hiring manager reading quickly will miss that you rebuilt the entire content function from scratch.

UNINTENTIONAL SIGNALS:

- Listing 14 tools and platforms signals breadth, not mastery - pick 5 and prove depth
- 'Assisted with' and 'supported the team on' appear 3 times - cut all assisted language immediately
- Two roles listed as 'contract' back-to-back raises retention questions that your cover letter will need to address

06 EXECUTIVE PRESENCE

Rating: Low - 48/100

LANGUAGE ANALYSIS:

Your language is functional but passive. You rely heavily on verbs like 'managed', 'assisted', 'supported', and 'coordinated' - all of which position you as a participant rather than a driver. Marketing Manager roles require language that signals ownership: 'led', 'built', 'launched', 'owned', 'scaled'. The difference is not cosmetic - it changes how a hiring manager categorises you before they've finished the first bullet.

GAPS TO ADDRESS:

- No evidence of budget ownership - even a small budget figure signals accountability
- Team leadership is implied but never stated - if you manage or mentor anyone, say so explicitly
- No evidence of cross-functional influence - did you work with sales, product, or leadership? Name it.
- Zero reference to business outcomes - revenue, pipeline, growth, retention, conversion

HOW TO FIX IT:

Audit every bullet and ask: 'Am I the person who did this, or the person who made this happen?' Rewrite from the second perspective. Add one sentence to your summary that explicitly states your leadership scope - headcount, budget, or function size. If you don't have direct reports, frame your influence: 'shaped content strategy across a 12-person growth team'.

07 HIDDEN ADVANTAGES

YOUR UNIQUE POSITIONING:

You have something most Marketing Manager candidates don't - you've been embedded in a scaling tech startup during a growth phase and have seen how marketing strategy changes as headcount doubles. That's genuinely rare and genuinely valuable to companies at Series A-B stage. The problem is your resume doesn't say any of this. It describes tasks without communicating the context that makes those tasks impressive.

OVERLOOKED STRENGTHS:

- You rebuilt the content function at Brightwave - that's a 'built from zero' story that's highly marketable
- Your agency background gives you a speed and versatility most in-house marketers lack
- You've worked across B2B and B2C - fewer candidates can credibly claim both
- Tool fluency across HubSpot, Salesforce, and GA4 is a genuine differentiator at this level

HOW TO AMPLIFY THEM:

- Lead your summary with the Brightwave rebuild story in one sentence - 'Built content function from zero to 40k monthly organic visitors'
- Add a 'Notable Wins' or 'Highlights' block at the top with your 3 best metrics
- Explicitly frame your agency experience as strategic advantage: 'brings agency pace to in-house teams'
- In every role, add one sentence that describes the state of the team or function when you joined vs when you left

08 INDUSTRY TRANSLATION GAPS

WHERE YOU LOSE THE READER:

- 'Managed social media calendar' - tech companies call this 'content operations' or 'editorial pipeline'
- 'Wrote blog posts' undersells what is likely SEO-optimised long-form content strategy
- 'Organised events' should be 'led demand generation events' or 'produced field marketing programs'
- Your agency role uses agency language - 'client deliverables', 'campaign briefs' - that doesn't translate to in-house tech

LANGUAGE TO ADOPT:

- Demand generation / demand gen
- Pipeline contribution
- Content-led growth
- Organic acquisition
- Brand-to-demand
- GTM execution
- MQL / SQL / conversion rate

HOW TO REFRAME:

- Replace 'managed social media calendar' with 'owned organic social strategy across LinkedIn and Instagram, growing engagement 34%'
- Replace 'wrote blog posts' with 'built SEO content engine targeting mid-funnel keywords, generating 40k monthly sessions'
- Replace 'organised events' with 'led 6 field marketing events contributing \$280k to pipeline'
- Add a single line in each tech role that connects marketing activity to business outcome: 'supported 3x revenue growth over 18-month period'

09 REWRITE SUGGESTIONS

Professional Summary

ORIGINAL:

"Results-driven marketing professional with 6 years of experience across digital, content, and brand. Passionate about creating compelling campaigns that drive engagement."

ISSUE:

This is the most forgettable kind of summary - generic, passive, and impossible to verify. 'Results-driven' and 'passionate' are filler words. There's no specificity, no proof, and no reason to keep reading.

DIRECTION:

Marketing Manager with 6 years building content and growth functions inside tech startups and agencies. Rebuilt Brightwave's content operation from scratch - grew organic traffic from 8k to 40k monthly sessions in 14 months. Now looking to own a marketing function at Series A-C stage where speed and commercial acumen matter more than process.

Brightwave Technologies - Key Achievement Bullet

ORIGINAL:

"Managed content calendar and oversaw blog production, social media, and email newsletters."

ISSUE:

This describes a process, not a contribution. Anyone who's worked in marketing can claim this. It communicates coordination, not ownership or impact.

DIRECTION:

Built and owned content function end-to-end - editorial calendar, SEO roadmap, email program, and social - growing organic sessions from 8k to 40k/month and reducing paid dependency by 22% within 14 months.

Skills Section

ORIGINAL:

"HubSpot, Salesforce, Google Analytics, Hootsuite, Mailchimp, Canva, WordPress, Asana, Slack, Figma, Trello, SEMrush, Ahrefs, Google Ads"

ISSUE:

14 tools listed as a flat comma-separated string. ATS can't parse this reliably, and hiring managers see this as a breadth list with no depth signal. It also includes tools like Slack and Trello that every professional uses - they don't belong in a skills section.

DIRECTION:

Core Competencies: Content Strategy / SEO & Organic Growth / Demand Generation / Marketing Ops / Brand & Positioning. Tech Stack: HubSpot (advanced) · Salesforce · GA4 · SEMrush · Ahrefs · Google Ads. Remove: Slack, Trello, Canva, Asana.

Agency Role - Job Title Framing

ORIGINAL:

"Marketing Coordinator - Handled client briefs, campaign execution, and monthly reporting for 8 B2B clients."

ISSUE:

'Handled' is one of the weakest action verbs in marketing writing. 'Client briefs' and 'monthly reporting' describe admin, not strategic contribution. This role is underselling agency experience that is genuinely valued in tech hiring.

DIRECTION:

Marketing Coordinator - Managed integrated campaign delivery for 8 B2B technology clients across paid, content, and email channels. Produced monthly performance reports tracking against CPL, CAC, and pipeline contribution targets.

Career Objective / Summary Positioning

ORIGINAL:

"Looking for a challenging marketing role where I can apply my skills and grow professionally."

ISSUE:

This sentence adds zero value and wastes valuable summary real estate. 'Looking for a challenging role to grow' is what every candidate wants - it's not a value proposition.

DIRECTION:

Delete entirely. Replace the summary with a forward-facing statement about the function you want to own and the commercial context you work best in. Hiring managers want to know what you'll do for them, not what you want for yourself.

10 NETWORKING STRATEGY

YOUR APPROACH:

For a Marketing Manager role in tech, LinkedIn outreach works but cold applications rarely convert above 3%. Your highest-leverage move is warm introductions through your Brightwave network - former colleagues, investors, founders you've met at events. Second priority: engage consistently on LinkedIn with content relevant to B2B marketing, demand gen, and SaaS growth. Hiring managers Google candidates. A LinkedIn presence that demonstrates expertise is a silent differentiator.

WHO TO TARGET:

- VP of Marketing at Series A-B startups (your direct hiring manager)
- Head of Content at scale-ups (peer-level, referral source)
- Marketing Recruiters specialising in tech (Hatch, The Orchard, Six Degrees)
- CMOs at companies you'd want to work for (connection request + genuine engagement)

CONNECTION MESSAGE TEMPLATE:

"Hi [Name], I've been following [Company]'s growth - the shift to content-led demand gen you've made over the past 12 months is exactly the direction I've been building toward. I'm a marketing manager with a background in scaling content functions for tech companies at the growth stage and I'd love a 15-minute conversation if you're open to it. No agenda - just a genuine interest in the work you're doing."

COMMUNITIES TO JOIN:

- Exit Five (Dave Gerhardt's B2B marketing community - where tech marketing managers actually hire)
- Demand Gen Visionaries Slack group
- Women in Tech Marketing (LinkedIn group, strong for referrals)
- Local startup events - Fishburners, Stone & Chalk, Startmate community events

11 POSITIONING STRATEGY

YOUR NARRATIVE ANGLE:

You're not a generalist who's done a bit of everything. You're a marketer who builds functions - takes ambiguity, creates structure, and generates measurable growth. That's a specific and valuable archetype for companies moving from early-stage chaos to scalable marketing operations. Own that story explicitly. It differentiates you from candidates with cleaner pedigree but less operator experience.

YOUR ELEVATOR PITCH:

"I build marketing functions for tech companies that have outgrown their scrappy phase. At Brightwave I rebuilt content from the ground up - took it from a blog with no strategy to a channel generating 40k visits a month. I'm looking for the next company that needs that kind of hands-on, commercially-minded marketing leadership."

LINKEDIN HEADLINE:

Marketing Manager | Content-Led Growth | Built Organic to 40k/mo at Brightwave | B2B & SaaS

KEYWORDS TO OWN:

Content-led growth - Demand generation - B2B marketing - Marketing Manager - SaaS marketing - Organic acquisition

12 LINKEDIN PROFILE REWRITE

HEADLINE:

Marketing Manager | Content Strategy & Demand Generation | SaaS & Tech Growth Stage

ABOUT SECTION:

I build marketing functions. Not campaigns - functions. The kind that work when you're not watching them. At Brightwave Technologies I inherited a blog and a hope and turned it into an organic engine generating 40,000 sessions a month. Before that, agency-side gave me the speed and the commercial discipline that most in-house marketers take years to develop. I work best inside companies that have found product-market fit and need marketing to actually pull weight - not just support sales, but generate pipeline independently. If that sounds like your company, let's talk.

EXPERIENCE FRAMING:

Lead with outcomes in every role, not responsibilities. First bullet for each role should answer: 'What was measurably different because you were there?' Frame your Brightwave role as a build story - what did you inherit, what did you create, what did it produce. For agency experience, frame it as the speed and breadth that in-house marketers lack.

FEATURED SECTION:

Pin two items: (1) A LinkedIn post showing a piece of content you're proud of - something that demonstrates your voice and marketing thinking. (2) A case study or results snapshot from the Brightwave content program. Even a simple PDF or Canva slide with before/after metrics is more compelling than a blank featured section.

13 30-DAY VISIBILITY SPRINT

Week 1 - Fix the foundations

- Rewrite summary using the narrative angle above - take no more than 45 minutes
- Audit every bullet: remove all 'assisted', 'supported', 'helped', and 'was responsible for' language
- Add metrics to your top 5 most impressive bullets - estimate if you don't have exact numbers
- Rebuild skills section as competencies + tech stack, remove all soft tools
- Update LinkedIn headline and About section with new positioning

Week 2 - Activate your warm network

- Message 5 former Brightwave colleagues to let them know you're actively looking
- Connect on LinkedIn with 10 VPs of Marketing and Heads of Content at companies you'd want to work for
- Ask your strongest former manager for a LinkedIn recommendation - frame the request with the specific story you want told
- Post once on LinkedIn this week - a short observation about something in B2B marketing or content strategy

Week 3 - Targeted applications

- Apply to 8-10 roles using the rewritten resume, tailoring the summary for each company
- For each application, find one person at the company on LinkedIn and send a short connection note
- Research the companies you've applied to - follow them, engage with their posts
- Join Exit Five and introduce yourself in the #jobs channel

Week 4 - Build visibility

- Post a second LinkedIn piece - a short breakdown of how you rebuilt the Brightwave content function
- Reach out to 2 marketing recruiters at Hatch or Six Degrees with a specific brief
- Follow up on any applications from week 3 that have gone quiet
- Review your application conversion rate - if less than 15% response rate, it's the resume not the market